

KARENSMITHRAWNSLEY PARK EDIT

Travel Radio Australia. Now, staying on a real Australian farm is a dream that people both in Australia and from outside Australia have and I'm catching up with Deborah Pierce who's from Rornsley Park Station in the Barossa Valley and they have another property in the Flinders Ranges and we're here at the world travel market in London. Deborah, welcome to the program.

Hi, Jeff. Thanks so much for having me. Now, tell us about this fantastic Rornsley Park Station for start off.

That's in the... people can come and visit and you organize everything for them. Yeah, absolutely. So, Rornsley Park Station located up in the Flinders Ranges, four and a half hours drive out of Adelaide, just a fantastic place to come and stay.

If you're looking to get away from it all and explore everything that Flinders has got to offer, so that sort of red centre, outback, soft adventure experience. We've got lots of different accommodation ranges, so we've got everything from the camping and caravan site, through to holiday units, through to our sort of four-star luxury eco villas, for people to say, so a whole range of accommodation and you can come out and stay with us, you can learn all about the ancient geology, the rocks that are dated back five billion years, you can spot the kidneys and little yellow fitted rock wallabies and kangaroos and emus and all that sort of stuff that I know that international travellers like to come and see. You're overlooking Wilpina Pound, you're literally just moments away from the ichor of Flinders National Park, so walking, hiking, relaxing and taking in amazing visitors and scenery.

We've got it all going on, we're a third-generation owner-operated sheep station to this day, we have a restaurant on site, we're just an all-round amazing place to come and stay if you want to get away from it all. Sounds absolutely fantastic and I've had experience of this, so when I was 19 I lived on a 2,000 acre property in young New South Wales and it's a working sheep farm as well. The actual experiences you have in that are so special and the weather, the vistas, the sunsets, the sunrises, just fantastic and you have another property as well, tell us a bit about that.

Yes we do, I should clarify, I'm obviously not an Aussie, I'm a Brit so I'm just representing the owners over here in the UK at this amazing trade show but their second property is in the Barossa Valley, it's a collection of six cottages right in the middle of the vineyard, Barossa-Schrazza State, so it's perfect for people that are looking to come away, spend a couple of nights in the heart of the Barossa Valley, do all those amazing wine tastings, indulge in the incredible produce that you can get there but stay in your own secluded, luxury, private, cottage accommodation. So we've got six cottages and they range inside from one bedroom, one bathroom, three bedrooms and two bathroom properties, so if you're a couple of couples coming away together it's great, if you're a family it's also a really great option or if you're just a couple traveling together, so so much come and stay right in the heart of the vineyard, walking just in

some of the wineries, walking just to restaurants, all the wine tours pick up and drop off at our properties, so absolutely wonderful areas and have you been to Australia, I suppose you've been and visited and tell me about your experience at these properties. I've been really really fortunate to work with Australia for over 30 years and so I've been out quite a few times now but I was last at these properties in 2019, had an amazing stay at the Barossa-Schrazza State, visited some incredible wineries like the Battlefield, tried their port, just a really really lovely time and then went up to stay at Walter Park Station, so you can combine the two properties really nicely together, so Barossa is an hour outside of Adelaide and then it's about a further four-hour drive from the Barossa Valley up to Royal Sea Park Station, that is the most magical place and that's the only way I can describe it, there's a bridge coming to somewhere so isolated, so raw, the enormous skies, the incredible rocks and the rock formation, learning all about geology which I'm not quite as interested in but was by the time I came back, the guides up at Walter Park Station are really amazing, going for the walks, yeah just the most incredible experience.

And of course out there in the Barossa Valley and Flinders Ranges where they filmed so many movies in South Australia and the thing is that once you're out there out of the city the nighttime vistas, the stars are just incredible. Oh the stars are amazing and if you stay in our luxury eco villas you've actually got blinds that you can retract above your bed at night so you can literally just lie in bed at night and just stargaze and these days we're so lucky with all the apps that we have on our phones so we can spot all those constellations, yeah absolutely no light pollution, absolutely amazing. And Deborah Pearce from Raunsley Park Station, she's based here in the UK but she's selling this all over the world, I suppose you have a fantastic range of visitors who come from all over the world for these places.

Yeah we do, so we get a lot of Aussies obviously coming today, it's a great destination for the domestic visitor, we also get a lot of Americans, there's a new United Airlines flight connecting America into Adelaide so we're a great option for American market. Now most people who come to our properties will self-drive and it's a great little road trip itinerary that you can put together but we've also got packages and options available including transfers from Adelaide so if you don't want to drive then we can sort that out for you as well. How can people find out more about your Raunsley Park Station online? Yeah of course, so Raunsley Park Station just go to www.raunsleypark.com.au and www.barosasharasestate.com.au those are our URLs or you can go through your trusted travel advisor.

Well we will point out that it's www.rawnsleypark.com.au and that's easy to get to and the other one is www.barosasharas.com.au and Deborah Pierce thank you so much for being on the program and we're all looking forward to come and visiting you in these fabulous places and the owners so yes a great home state. Thank you very much yeah go and say hi to Tony and Julie Smith the owners.